
The Stress- Body Connec- tion

Companion Workbook — map your personal stress
storage and build the body-side recovery practice

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

The Stress-Body Connection

Companion Workbook — map your personal stress storage and build the body-side recovery practice

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

HEALING HANDS BY NATE

The Stress-Body Connection

© 2026 Healing Hands By Nate. All rights reserved.

Nate Ratcliff, LMT

Inner Circle Deep Cut — #7 Workbook

For Healing Hands By Nate Inner Circle members. Personal use only. Please don't redistribute — share the membership instead.

Published by Healing Hands By Nate

Contents

1. How to use this workbook
2. Personal Stress Storage Map
3. Reflection Prompts
4. Body-Side Recovery Practice
5. 30-Day Storage Pattern Tracker
6. Mental Health Support Check
7. Seasonal Stress Patterns
8. Year-End Reflection
9. Try this for 7 days

Introduction

A YEAR-LONG COMPANION TO THE IC7 DEEP CUT.

Map your personal stress storage pattern and
build the body-side recovery practice.

CHAPTER 1

How to use this workbook

YEAR-LONG REFERENCE. USE THE STORAGE MAP self-assessment first to baseline. Then the daily/weekly trackers for ongoing awareness. Bring relevant pages to therapy too if you're doing that work.

CHAPTER 2

Personal Stress Storage Map

RUN THE 60-SECOND SCAN THREE TIMES PER DAY for one week. Mark where you find tension.

60-Second Scan Template

TIME: _____ DATE: _____

- ☐ Jaw – clenched / tongue pressed / masseter tight
- ☐ Forehead – furrowing / behind-eye tension
- ☐ Shoulders – up toward ears / hunched forward
- ☐ Chest – shallow breath / breath holding / tight front
- ☐ Stomach – tight belly / knotted feeling
- ☐ Low back – tight / hips clenched
- ☐ Hands – fists / fingers tight

Specific trigger right now (if any):

Daily Scan Log

DAY	AM TENSION SITES	MIDDAY	EVENING
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

After 7 days — Your storage pattern

My primary storage site (consistently tight):

My secondary storage sites: _____

My time of day with most tension: _____

My most common trigger: _____

CHAPTER 3

Reflection Prompts

PROMPT 1: WHERE IN YOUR BODY DID YOU CARRY stress as a child? Has that pattern continued into adulthood, or has it shifted?

Prompt 2: Name a stressful period in your life. Where does your body still hold that period? What hasn't released?

Prompt 3: If your body could discharge stored stress on demand, what would you most want to release? Why hasn't it released yet?

CHAPTER 4

Body-Side Recovery Practice

BUILD YOUR PERSONALIZED PRACTICE BASED ON your storage map.

My primary storage site is: _____

Daily tissue release for primary site: _____

Time and place I'll do it: _____

My nervous system retraining practice

- [] Daily breathing (Module 2) — **_ minutes at _** (time)
- [] Vagal technique (Module 4) — **_ technique at _** (time)
- [] Body scan (Module 1) — _____ times per day

Heat application schedule

- [] Morning hot shower with focus on _____
- [] Rice sock on _____ before bed
- [] Other: _____

Movement-as-discharge plan

- [] Walking ____ minutes per day
- [] Other physical activity: _____

Bodywork schedule

- [] Sessions every ____ weeks
 - [] Self-massage daily on _____
-

CHAPTER 5

30-Day Storage Pattern Tracker

DAY	PRIMARY SITE TENSION (0-10)	PRACTICE DONE? (Y/N)	NOTES
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			
15			
16			
17			
18			

DAY	PRIMARY SITE TENSION (0-10)	PRACTICE DONE? (Y/N)	NOTES
19			
20			
21			
22			
23			
24			
25			
26			
27			
28			
29			
30			

30-Day Reflection

AVERAGE PRIMARY SITE TENSION (DAYS 1-7 vs 24-30): _ → ____

Days I did the practice: ____ out of 30

What’s the biggest change?

What still needs work?

CHAPTER 6

Mental Health Support Check

HONEST ASSESSMENT — CHECK ANYTHING THAT applies over the past month:

- [] Anxiety significantly impairing daily function
- [] Persistent depression lasting more than 2-3 weeks
- [] Panic attacks
- [] Trauma symptoms (intrusive memories, hypervigilance, emotional flashbacks)
- [] Substance use increasing as coping
- [] Suicidal thoughts — **contact 988 immediately**
- [] Stress patterns tied to specific past events you keep returning to
- [] Relationship dynamics you can't seem to shift on your own

If any of these are checked — body work alone isn't enough. Please access professional mental health support.

Therapist (if you have one): _____

Next appointment: ____

If you don't have one yet — date you'll look into it: ____

CHAPTER 7

Seasonal Stress Patterns

Spring

DATE: ____

Spring stress level (1-10): [__]

Primary storage site this season: _____

Summer

Date: ____

Summer stress level (1-10): [__]

Primary storage site this season: _____

Fall

Date: ____

Fall stress level (1-10): [__]

Primary storage site this season: _____

Winter

Date: __

Winter stress level (1-10): [__]

Primary storage site this season: _____

CHAPTER 8

Year-End Reflection

COMPARED TO ONE YEAR AGO, MY STRESS
patterns are:

- ☐ Significantly more regulated
- ☐ Somewhat more regulated
- ☐ About the same
- ☐ Somewhat less regulated
- ☐ Significantly less regulated

Biggest shift this year:

What worked most consistently:

Did I get the mental health support I needed? ☐ Yes / ☐ In progress / ☐ No, still need to

Commitment for next year:

CHAPTER 9

Try this for 7 days

IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK, try this:

Three 60-second body scans per day for one week. AM, midday, evening. Just observe — don't try to change anything.

That's the foundational practice. By day 7 you'll have your personal stress storage map.

Once you know your storage map, the rest of the work — daily tissue release, nervous system practices, bodywork, possibly therapy — has a clear target.

Bring this workbook to your next session.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
LMT and published by Healing Hands By
Nate.